

GUIDELINES FOR THE PREPARATION OF REPORTS BY MEMBER STATES ON THE APPLICATION OF THE 1960 CONVENTION AND RECOMMENDATION AGAINST DISCRIMINATION IN EDUCATION

Preparation of the 11th Consultation

Combating discrimination in education

Eleventh consultation of Member States on the application of the Convention and the Recommendation against Discrimination in Education (1960) (2024-2025)

GUIDELINES FOR THE PREPARATION OF REPORTS BY MEMBER STATES ON THE APPLICATION OF THE 1960 CONVENTION AND RECOMMENDATION AGAINST DISCRIMINATION IN EDUCATION

1. Introduction

The Convention against Discrimination in Education (“the Convention”) and the Recommendation against Discrimination in Education (“the Recommendation”), adopted by UNESCO’s General Conference in 1960, are aligned with UNESCO’s constitutional mandate to “advance the ideal of equality of educational opportunities without regard to race, sex or any distinctions, economic or social”. The Convention is the first legally binding international instrument focused on the **right to education** and the only one exclusively dedicated to it.

The right to education is one of the key principles underpinning the Education 2030 agenda and Sustainable Development Goal 4 (SDG4) adopted by the international community in 2015. SDG 4 seeks to ensure the full enjoyment of the right to education as fundamental to achieving sustainable development. Its scope captures the multidimensional nature of the right to education.

Representing a powerful tool to advance SDG 4 by ensuring effective articulation between normative and operational work, the Convention has been recognized as a cornerstone of Education 2030 agenda.

The present Guidelines are intended to assist Member States in the preparation of country reports on the implementation of the Convention and the Recommendation in the context of the 11th consultation.

2. Scope of the Consultation

Considering the Education 2030 agenda, the monitoring of the Convention and the Recommendation is of crucial importance to ensure an education that is truly inclusive for all and to counter persistent inequalities in access, participation and learning outcomes at all levels, particularly for the most vulnerable groups. This is particularly true under the current context in which countries are making efforts to recover from the learning disruption caused by the COVID-19 pandemic. Concrete measures taken by countries in accordance with their legal obligations under these instruments contribute to implementing the Education 2030 agenda.

As the scope and content of the legal obligations under the right to education are aligned with the 10 targets of SDG 4, efforts are being made to ensure that the components of the targets are included in the guidelines and that these guidelines serve as a valuable contribution to monitoring progress towards SDG 4 targets.

Beyond SDG 4, the Convention is also closely aligned with the normative content on the right to education of other international human rights instruments such as the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966), Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of

Discrimination against Women (1979), the Convention on the Rights of the Child (1989) and the Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities (2006).

In addition, this Consultation is an opportunity to inform the ongoing **UNESCO Initiative on the Evolving Right to Education within a lifelong learning perspective**¹ (launched in December 2021). The Initiative investigates how the right to education could be reinforced placing it within a lifelong learning perspective and in light of the new demands being placed on education. This Initiative builds on the **Report from the International Commission on the Futures of Education**², which suggests to broaden our understanding of the right to education to clearly apply it to all ages and across all times and spaces. The initiative is also in-line with the **Vision Statement of the United Nations Secretary General on Transforming Education**³, and the **Report on the 2022 Transforming Education Summit**⁴ which call for the transformation of education systems to 'include everyone, regardless of circumstance, context or background'. The Initiative on the Evolving Right to Education aims to open a collaborative and participatory discussion about the international framework to ensure the effective enforcement of the right to education and learning throughout life for all. Finally, the Initiative builds on recent inter-governmental dialogues, including the Marrakech Framework for Action for Adult Learning and Education⁵ and the Tashkent Declaration on Early Childhood Care and Education.⁶

It is also important to note that previous consultations on the Convention and Recommendation revealed that countries now understand the right to education in an extended manner. The 11th consultation builds on the findings of the previous national reports to include various areas that have direct repercussions on the right to education such as, for instance, digital learning, climate considerations, lifelong learning entitlement, and the role of non-state actors in education.

3. Reporting obligations

There are differences in the legal nature of the obligations under the Convention, as distinguished from those under the Recommendation. The Convention has binding force and the States Parties are under the obligation to incorporate its provisions into their domestic frameworks. The Recommendation, non-binding in nature, has political and moral force. Its adoption sought to take into account the difficulties that certain States might experience in ratifying the Convention, in particular with respect to their federal structure.

Bearing in mind the differences in legal scope inherent to the nature of these two categories of instruments, the content of the Recommendation is identical to that of the Convention. Member States are expected to give effect to it in national legislation and education policies.

The reporting obligation under the provisions of Article VII of the Convention and of the Recommendation is the same. Article VIII of UNESCO's Constitution states that "*Each Member State shall submit to the Organization, at such times and in such manner as shall be determined by the General Conference, reports on the laws, regulations and statistics relating to its educational, scientific and cultural institutions and activities, and on the action taken upon the recommendations and conventions referred to in Article IV, paragraph 4*". Therefore, even if a country is not a State Party to the Convention, it needs to submit a report on the implementation of the Recommendation, which means that **all UNESCO Member States are expected to submit a national report** on the implementation of these instruments in the context of monitoring consultations.

¹ <https://www.unesco.org/en/right-education/evolving>

² <https://unesdoc.unesco.org/ark:/48223/pf0000379707>

³ https://www.un.org/sites/un2.un.org/files/2022/09/sg_vision_statement_on_transforming_education.pdf

⁴ https://www.un.org/sites/un2.un.org/files/report_on_the_2022_transforming_education_summit.pdf

⁵ [Marrakech Framework for Action | Institute for Lifelong Learning \(unesco.org\)](https://www.unesco.org/en/marrakech-framework-for-action)

⁶ [Tashkent-declaration-ecce-2022.pdf \(unesco.org\)](https://www.unesco.org/en/tashkent-declaration-ecce-2022)

4. Participation in consultations

The reporting period for the 11th consultation on the implementation of the Convention and the Recommendation covers four years (2021-2024).

The Futures of Education Report calls for a new social contract for education, which requires to understand education as a common good and a shared societal endeavour. To ensure this, extensive consultations involving a broad range of stakeholders is needed. The reporting process therefore needs to be **participatory**. This includes ensuring cooperation between ministries of education and other ministries dealing with aspects of the right to education as well as consulting social partners and **civil society organizations** and other relevant bodies.

The preparation of national reports provides a **good opportunity** for Member States to assess the implementation of the right to education in their country, identify specific challenges, build constructive dialogue with other actors involved in this field and share good practices.

In the preparation of reports, Member States are encouraged to provide **substantive and relevant information in a concise manner**. In addition to a description of the constitutional, legislative, administrative, and policy framework established for the implementation of the provisions guaranteed by the instruments, the information supplied by Member States should demonstrate how legal norms and practices comply with the Convention and the Recommendation.

Relevant information supplied for other reporting instances may be reproduced or referred to with precise indication as to its retrieval. Similarly, hyperlinks to any useful documents or relevant legal and policy texts are most welcome and texts can also be added in the annex.

Country reports submitted for previous consultations can be found on the **Observatory on the right to education**⁷ in the monitoring section of the country profile. The information provided in the reports are valuable both for the Observatory on the right to education as well as for **HerAtlas**⁸, the online monitoring tool for girls' and women's right to education. Information and data regarding countries' education systems are also available through the UNESCO Institute for Statistics database⁹. Beyond monitoring purposes, the consultation findings and reports inform broader work - serving for knowledge generation, advocacy, and technical cooperation.

5. Modalities and structure

The Guidelines are structured around three chapters:

- The **first chapter** covers general information on adherence to the Convention.
- The **second chapter** aims to gather information on the implementation of the Convention and Recommendation in the context of Sustainable Development Goal 4. As the most extensive part of the Guidelines, this chapter covers: inclusion and non-discrimination in education (section 1), all levels and forms of education (section 2), quality education provision and learning environment (section 3) and finally, strengthening governance systems (section 4).
- The **third chapter** seeks to obtain information on the methods used to draw the attention of the various authorities in the country to the instruments.

With a view to simplify the Guidelines while providing necessary substantive information to assist Member States in the preparation of responses, through a participatory process, **two types of guidance** are provided:

⁷ <http://www.unesco.org/education/edurights/index.php?action=home&lng=en>

⁸ <https://en.unesco.org/education/girls-women-rights>

⁹ [UIS Statistics \(unesco.org\)](http://uis.unesco.org)

- (1) Open-ended and closed-ended questions to be directly filled in by Member States. Please note that multiple answers may be provided where relevant.
- (2) Additional information aimed at guiding Members States to structure and detail their responses to the open-ended questions (including remarks on how to respond efficiently to the questions raised). These elements are presented in italics.

GENERAL INFORMATION:

Country name: **Singapore**

Organization or entity responsible for the preparation of the report: **Ministry of Education**

Name of contact person: **Chia Kai Tiak Elias**

Email and telephone number of contact person: chia_kai_tiak@moe.gov.sg; +65 6879 7059

I. Ratification and applicability of the Convention against Discrimination in Education¹⁰

- Is your country a State Party to the Convention?

☐ Yes

☒ No: Does your country plan to ratify this instrument?

☐ Yes: Please indicate the stage of ratification process reached by your country and whether assistance is needed:

☐ There is interest but no concrete action has been taken

☐ The ratification process has been initiated

☐ The ratification process is close to completion

- Please briefly explain the steps that have been taken and timeline when relevant, any difficulties encountered (legal, institutional, political or practical) in completing the ratification process. And how UNESCO can assist:

☒ No, not considering ratification. Please explain why:

While Singapore does not plan to ratify the Convention, Singapore appreciates the significant work undertaken in the Convention and its contribution to ensure education as a fundamental right without any form of discrimination. Singapore continues to share the Convention's vision for a full enjoyment of the right to education as a cornerstone to achieve sustainable development. We have taken the necessary steps to ensure this, taking into account our unique national context.

- Is the Convention directly applicable in your country's domestic law?

☐ Yes ☒ No

- Have courts, tribunals and/or administrative authorities adjudicated on issues or violations regarding the right to education?¹¹

☒ No

☐ Yes: Have the provisions of the Convention been invoked?

☐ Yes ☐ No

- Please cite the case law and jurisprudence.

Information could also be given about the judicial, administrative and other competent authorities having jurisdiction with respect to the right to education.

II. Information on the implementation of the Convention or Recommendation in the context of Sustainable Development Goal 4 (SDG4)

1. Towards an inclusive non-discriminatory education system

For reference: This section relates to the main purpose of the Convention/Recommendation that is to underscore the state obligation to proscribe any form of discrimination in education while promoting equality of educational opportunity as laid out in Articles/Paragraphs 1(1), 2 and 3 of the Convention/Recommendation.

*It further corresponds to the overall aspiration of SDG4 which aims to “**ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all**” by 2030. While it covers all the SDG4 targets, it also specifically covers SDG target 4.5.¹²*

- Please indicate whether the rights and principles laid out in the Convention/Recommendation informed the elaboration of the education legal and/or policy framework:

☐ Yes ☒ No

- If yes, please provide reference:

Not applicable.

1.1 Non-discrimination and equality in education

¹¹ Judicial mechanisms play an important role in enforcing the right to education by ensuring legal accountability and therefore contributing to the practical realization of the right to education.

¹² Which calls on states to “eliminate gender disparities in education and ensure equal access to all levels of education and vocational training for the vulnerable, including persons with disabilities, indigenous peoples and children in vulnerable situations”.

- Please indicate measures adopted to both prevent and eliminate discrimination in education within the meaning of the Convention/Recommendation¹³, and ensure equal access to all levels and types of education (please tick all that apply):

For reference: This notably is covered under SDG target 4.1 and partly target 4.b¹⁴

☒ Legal texts¹⁵ prohibit discrimination and guarantee equal access to education:

- ☒ In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)
- ☒ In primary education
- ☒ In secondary education
- ☐ In technical and vocational education and training
- ☒ In higher education
- ☐ In adult education and alternative learning

- Please indicate the relevant legal provisions:

Article 16(1) of the Constitution of the Republic of Singapore (provides that there shall be no discrimination against any Singapore citizen on the grounds only of religion, race, descent or place in the administration of any educational institution maintained by a public authority, and in the admission of pupils or students or the payments or fees).

- Please list the prohibited grounds of discrimination in education as laid out in legal texts:

Religion, race, descent or place of birth.

☒ Policies, programmes and initiatives aim to prohibit and prevent discrimination and ensure equal access to education

- ☒ In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)
- ☒ In primary education
- ☒ In secondary education
- ☒ In technical and vocational education and training
- ☒ In higher education
- ☒ In adult education and alternative learning

¹³ See: Article/Paragraph 1(1).

¹⁴ Which calls on states to "substantially expand globally the number of scholarships available [...] for enrolment in higher education, including vocational training and information and communications technology, technical, engineering and scientific programmes".

¹⁵ Constitution, laws, decrees, regulations, circulars, etc.

- Please provide details:

Singapore believes in education as a social leveler. All programmes and pathways are available to students, regardless of race, gender, or socio-economic background. Singapore has embarked on efforts to ensure that children from disadvantaged backgrounds receive sufficient and continuous support throughout their educational journey.

A conducive home environment and preschool education during a child's early years are key to better outcomes later in life. Lower-income families, however, may find it harder to support the early childhood needs of their young children due to limited resources and bandwidth tax. To address this, the Government provides additional support to lower-income families by making preschool education more (1) affordable and (2) accessible. The Government also seeks to (3) level early childhood opportunities for such families in the preschool and home settings.

- Affordability.

- All lower-income families with a gross monthly household income of \$6,000 and below qualify for maximum childcare subsidies based on their income tier. This means that children from lower-income families attending a government-supported preschool can pay as low as \$3 for full-day childcare or \$1 for half-day kindergarten per month. Families living in public rental flats under the Housing Development Board's (HDB) Public Rental Scheme and/or receiving MSF's ComCare financial assistance, are also automatically eligible for maximum preschool subsidies.
- Lower-income families experiencing difficult family circumstances, and who require further assistance with preschool fees after receiving subsidies, may apply for additional assistance such as the Child Care Financial Assistance and/or Start Up Grant. The latter is a one-time grant to cover the initial costs of enrolling their child in an affordable infant or childcare centre in Singapore.

- Accessibility. All lower-income families have priority enrolment into Government-supported preschools.

- Levelling Opportunity.

- Parents play a key role in the development of their children. The KidSTART programme equips parents from eligible lower-income families with the skills and knowledge to support their children's development, from the antenatal stage until the child is 6 years old. KidSTART is being expanded nationwide and the expansion will complete in 2025.
- We are shifting from episodic social assistance to partnering with families and supplementing their efforts towards their longer-term goals. Under ComLink+, Social Service Office (SSO) family coaches and Family Service Centre (FSC) case workers work and journey with eligible lower-income families to achieve stability, self-reliance, and social mobility across different six domains (income security, financial resilience, family functioning, health, children's development and education, and housing). For ComLink+ families with young children, family coaches and FSC case workers facilitate child immunisations, timely preschool enrolment, and regular preschool attendance.

ComLink+ families can also benefit from the ComLink+ Progress Package for Preschool, which provides financial top-ups to families that enrol their children in preschool in the year they turn three and ensure regular attendance.

- Children from lower-income families may also require additional learning and attendance support in preschool. This is why, from April 2024, ECDA has also provided more resources to selected preschools to equip them in providing effective and timely support to children from lower-income families. This includes providing learning support, monitoring children's attendance and working with parents to address challenges in sending their children to preschool regularly.

Beyond financial assistance, MOE supports our students from disadvantaged backgrounds to achieve their fullest potential through MOE's coordinated UPLIFT efforts, in partnership with other agencies and the community. Through UPLIFT, MOE has dedicated additional resources to schools, established after-school support and leveraged partnerships between schools and the community to strengthen upstream wraparound support disadvantaged students and their families across primary and secondary schools. For instance, primary schools work with community partners to proactively enrol disadvantaged students into school-based Student Care Centres, which provide a supervised, conducive environment and targeted programmes to engage them meaningfully. Secondary schools focus on building socio-emotional competencies and improving connectedness to learning, peers and school through after-school engagement programmes under GEAR-UP. Students are engaged through befriending and mentoring by partners and volunteers, and interest-based activities that build peer support and relationships. UPLIFT also leverages community efforts and resources more systematically to address multi-faceted issues faced by disadvantaged students and their families. Schools partner the social services to customise financial and non-financial assistances for the family, employment support for the parents, and children and youth services like drop-in centres and academic coaching for the children. These efforts help to ensure a stable home environment to better meet students' educational needs. In 2023, UPLIFT supported about 16,500 students in around 300 schools.

As part of the **National Digital Literacy Programme**, every secondary school student owns a Personal Learning Device (PLD) such as a laptop or tablet since 2021 to access educational technology tools and resources, especially the Singapore Student Learning Space (SLS), Singapore's national online learning platform, which provides curriculum-aligned resources and system tools to all students. To help defray the cost of the PLDs, MOE has provided Edusave top-ups annually since 2020 to all eligible Singaporean students in primary and secondary schools. Students from low-income households receive additional support so that there will be no out-of-pocket payment for the purchase of the PLD. MOE has provided all primary schools with sufficient internet-enabled devices to support students' learning in school. In cases where primary school students need to use devices after school hours but lack digital devices, schools can loan computers and internet-enabling devices to students who need to use the devices at home for school work. Students also have the option to use the computing facilities in school. Subsidised broadband and digital devices are also available to eligible low-income Singaporean households with school-going children via the Infocomm Media Development Authority's DigitalAccess@Home scheme.

Schools and Institutes of Higher Learning (IHLs) are committed to providing a supportive and safe environment for all students, MOE takes a serious view of all forms of hurtful behaviour, from one-off insensitive remarks to more persistent, intentional acts of bullying, including physical and sexual violence, and gender-based bullying. **School rules and disciplinary frameworks** are clearly and regularly communicated. Similarly, IHL staff and students are briefed on their respective **Codes of Conduct** when they first join the IHL, such as during induction for staff and orientation for students. Schools and IHLs also make channels accessible for the safe reporting of cases and take educative, preventive and intervention measures to address them promptly.

When alleged sexual harassment or bullying is reported, trained school personnel will investigate, decide on appropriate disciplinary action and provide counselling support for students involved and decide on appropriate disciplinary action. In the IHLs, there are **compulsory modules on respect and appropriate behaviour** for students. These cover the importance of respecting boundaries, exhibiting appropriate behaviour and how to manage situations when boundaries are disrespected. Beyond education, parents and community groups also play a crucial role in supporting students to stand up against acts of sexual harassment or/ bullying and raise these concerns to their respective schools.

☒ Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum:

☒ In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)

☒ In primary education

☒ In secondary education

☒ In technical and vocational education and training

☒ In higher education

☐ In adult education and alternative learning

- Please provide details:

MOE's school curriculum emphasises the importance of non-discrimination to students, with opportunities for learning and discussion. Through the **Character and Citizenship Education curriculum** in schools, students are taught the importance of respect, care, empathy, and how to establish and respect boundaries for themselves and others, as well as understand the consequences of overstepping these boundaries. Students are also equipped to look out for their peers in distress and to seek help from trusted adults in school.

As early as preschool, children are taught the importance of showing care and respect for others. Educators design meaningful experiences for children.

All students are taught that respect should be accorded to all. Students learn not to stereotype and to appreciate individuals for their unique qualities, strengths and talents.

The History and Social Studies curricula, which span from primary to pre-university levels, include topics that examine the consequences of prejudice and discrimination.

Through the study of specific societies, events, and issues, students learn about the importance of respecting individuals for their differences, upholding peace, and maintaining harmony in diverse societies. In upper secondary Social Studies, students explore the rights and responsibilities of citizens in a country through different examples. For instance, they learn about children having the rights and access to quality education, regardless of their family background and the efforts made by different stakeholders in Singapore to support them. Students are also encouraged to appreciate the diversity that makes up the society that they live in and reflect on their roles and responsibilities in promoting and building an inclusive and harmonious society.

In the Institutes of Higher Learning (IHLs), topics covered include the importance of healthy relationships and gender equality, and modules on respect and appropriate behaviour for students.

☐ Other measures adopted to both prevent and eliminate discrimination in education and ensure equal access to all levels and types of education:

1.2 Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education

- Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (*several items may be ticked*):

General measures:

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☒ Legislation provides for inclusive education for all | ☒ Multiple and flexible learning pathways ¹⁷ are provided for |
| ☒ Policy measures aim to enhance inclusion in education for all | ☒ Curricula and teaching methods are inclusive in design ¹⁸ |
| ☒ Teachers are trained on inclusive education ¹⁶ and to value diversity | ☒ Multilingual and intercultural education is supported |
| ☒ Initiatives to address discrimination and promote cultural diversity and mutual acceptance | |
| ☐ Other: | |

¹⁶ Teachers are prepared to teach all student (beyond just students with disabilities), equipping them with knowledge, values and attitudes that permit every student to succeed. See: [UNESCO policy paper](#): Inclusive teaching: preparing all teachers to teach all students, 2020, p.14.

¹⁷ Multiple and flexible learning pathways are 'entry points and re-entry points at all ages and all educational levels, strengthened links between formal and non-formal structures, and recognition, validation and accreditation of the knowledge, skills and competencies acquired through nonformal and informal education' ([Education 2030 Framework for Action](#), para. 33). This may include student transfers between courses and institutions and diverse learning modalities (online, in-person, full-time, part-time, etc.) to respond to individual needs and interests.

¹⁸ In designing the curricula and teaching methods, care is given to ensure that all students are provided with an inclusive and supportive learning experience that offers them the opportunity to succeed whatever their background.

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

Equality of opportunities

Singapore is a small country which invests heavily in education to help our people achieve their full potential. Education remains an important social leveller. We are committed to providing high-quality and affordable education to all Singaporeans, regardless of their background. Our principles of meritocracy and equal access to opportunities have ensured that all Singaporeans have equal access to education.

All Singaporeans have equal and full access to quality education, including those with disabilities. Singapore's Compulsory Education Act, which was extended to include children with moderate-to-severe disabilities born after 1 Jan 2012, ensure that all children have the right to government-funded primary education, unless granted an exemption.

Inclusive education

Singapore's educational policy is inclusive and supports the education of children with disabilities as well as other developmental and learning needs. In the preschool sector, the Government is working with the sector towards every preschool appointing a staff as an Inclusion Coordinator (ICO). About 90% of preschools now have ICOs appointed who are trained to work with their fellow early childhood educators to identify children with potential developmental needs for further assessment and refer educators and parents to relevant early intervention resources and services. The Government has also piloted an Inclusive Support Programme (InSP) to integrate early childhood and early intervention services at preschools for children aged 3 to 6, who require medium levels of early intervention support.

MOE works closely with SG Enable and the Special Education (SPED) sector to ensure that SPED schools are adequately resourced to support students with higher support needs. The majority of children with disabilities and special educational needs are enrolled in mainstream schools and around 20% of them are enrolled in government and community-funded SPED schools.

Students with disabilities in mainstream schools benefit from specialised manpower, including teachers and school-based personnel trained in implementing inclusive education practices. Dedicated teachers receive in-depth courses on pedagogical strategies to support diverse learning needs. For instance, Physical Education (PE) lessons and outdoor education activities are adapted to ensure students with disabilities can participate meaningfully alongside their peers.

Mainstream schools tap on a special needs grant to purchase resources and fund learning activities for students with disabilities. Educational Psychologists work closely with schools to implement appropriate classroom and learning interventions to develop these students' learning, socio-emotional and behavioural needs. Social service agencies and health organisations also provide specialised services for students with physical/sensory and socio-emotional needs.

Students with higher needs who would benefit from more intensive and specialised interventions are supported in SPED schools, which are resourced with specialised facilities to meet higher needs. SPED schools provide either the national or customised curriculum, with pedagogy delivered by specially-trained teachers, together with support from allied

professionals such as psychologists, therapists and social workers. The National SPED Curriculum provides comprehensive guidance to SPED schools to enable them to customise a quality curriculum that equips their students with the knowledge, skills and attributes to lead independent lives, learn continuously and contribute meaningfully to society.

To facilitate purposeful and sustained interactions between students from SPED schools and their peers from mainstream schools, meaningful joint activities such as sports, camps and learning journeys are organised through School Partnerships¹⁹. Annually, MOE collaborates with community partners such as Special Olympics Singapore and Sport Singapore to promote inclusivity in the community through shared sporting experiences between students with and without disabilities. For example, students from SPED and mainstream schools train together before they compete with other combined teams in the Play Inclusive event. These partnerships help students become more empathetic, inclusive, and thoughtful, and enhance staff capabilities to foster inclusivity in schools. The bilingual policy, a cornerstone of our education system, requires students to offer two languages: English Language and an official Mother Tongue Language. This enables them to connect with people from different backgrounds in a multi-cultural environment, and allow them to thrive in a diverse, globalised world.

There are many opportunities for students to learn about other cultures within and beyond our shores, cultivate cross-cultural skills, and develop a global outlook. These include overseas immersion programmes and local learning journeys to cultural heritage sites such as Chinatown, Little India and Kampong Glam. Furthermore, Mother Tongue Language classes help our students to develop cross-cultural perspectives. Schools conduct the Conversational Chinese and Malay programme to encourage students to learn an additional language beyond their Mother Tongue. Those who are keen can also take up a third language in school to strengthen their cultural awareness.

- In general, what challenges were encountered in the implementation of non-discrimination and equal opportunities principles in education? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

Not applicable.

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Legislation provides for gender equality in education | ☒ All barriers for pregnant girls and young mothers in education are eliminated to ensure the continuity of their education |
| ☒ Policy measures aim to enhance gender equality | ☐ Re-entry programmes for young mothers are provided for |
| ☒ Gender-responsive education sector planning is undertaken | ☒ Ensuring safe and adequate gender-sensitive sanitation facilities ²¹ |

¹⁹ School Partnerships is a school-led partnership programme, where a planned and gradual approach seeks to develop self-confidence and the needed social-communication skills to foster successful interactions between students with disabilities and their peers.

²¹ 'Gender-sensitive sanitation includes clean, safe and separate toilets, with access to water and garbage disposal' ([UNGEI blog post](#), Gender-sensitive sanitation, 2018)

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Providing positive or affirmative action measures | ☒ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes ²² and bias |
| ☐ Providing financial incentives and fellowships | ☒ Ensuring gender parity in science, technology, engineering and mathematics (STEM) |
| ☒ Teachers are trained (initial and in-service) on gender equality | ☒ Ensuring gender parity in technical and vocational training education and training (TVET) |
| ☒ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation ²⁰ | |
| ☐ Other: | |

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

In Singapore, we are committed to providing high-quality and affordable education to all Singaporeans, regardless of their background. Our principles of meritocracy and equal access to opportunities have ensured that all Singaporeans have equal access to education.

Women in Singapore have made great strides in education since independence. Our enrolment and completion rates are high. Currently, over 97% of each Primary 1 cohort, of which roughly half are girls, complete their secondary education and progress to a post-secondary education institution. They have achieved high literacy rates: 96.4% in 2021 (for resident females aged 15 years and older) as compared to 32.8% in 1960. The proportion of university graduates who are female has been stable at around 50% from 2018 to 2022, reflecting the equal representation of male and female students in universities. There are no barriers for pregnant girls and young mothers to continue education.

Singapore takes a holistic and age-appropriate approach to promote gender equality (and counter gender stereotypes) across the education system. Students from as young as 6-7 years old are taught to appreciate the equity of roles, regardless of gender, in school, in the family and at the workplace. Students learn to appreciate that families are unique, that roles played by males and females in the family differ from family to family, the equality of parenting roles and the importance of not ascribing gender stereotypes in parenting, and that family responsibilities like caregiving, household chores and income-generation are not tied to gender.

As early as preschool, students are taught the importance of showing care and respect for others. Educators design meaningful experiences for children. The learning goals are not gender specific. All students learn that respect should be accorded to all, regardless of gender. Students are taught not to stereotype and to appreciate individuals for their unique qualities, strengths and talents.

In our national curriculum, students are exposed to a healthy representation of both women and men in all levels of schooling. The experiences, contributions, and achievements of women are highlighted alongside that of their male counterparts. Students have opportunities to discuss issues related to women's development, particularly in the languages and humanities subjects. In the Institutes of Higher Learning (IHLs), topics covered

²⁰ 'Stigmatisation is the act of treating someone or something unfairly by publicly disapproving of them' (Cambridge Dictionary).

²² Stereotype is a set idea that people have about what someone or something is like, especially an idea that is wrong' (Cambridge Dictionary).

include the importance of healthy relationships and gender equality, and modules on respect and appropriate behaviour for students.

We recognise that students may be influenced by inaccurate media portrayals or implicit bias in society to pursue stereotypical gender roles in their careers. Education and Career Guidance Counsellors guide students to recognise how gender stereotypes may limit education or career pathways. Students are encouraged to understand their interests and strengths, and to explore career sectors accordingly. Students can access resources with a balanced representation of genders across careers in the MySkillsFuture Student portal, including resources to support students in their journey of self-discovery, industry videos and write ups about careers and their requirements, and features on role models, such as female alumni successful in Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics (STEM) fields.

In schools, both boys and girls have equal access to STEM subjects. Singapore continues to encourage students, both boys and girls, to consider careers in STEM so that they can benefit from the digital future. Women are also well-represented in STEM courses in the Institutes of Higher Learning (IHLs) as female students enrolled in STEM courses at IHLs has been stable at close to 4 in 10 (40%). Females were also well-represented in the enrolment of specific courses in 2022 as follows: a) 68% of enrolment in applied & health sciences courses at ITE; b) 65% of enrolment in the natural, physical and mathematical sciences courses at polytechnics; and c) 57% of enrolment in natural, physical and mathematical sciences courses in universities. There are also programmes (e.g. NTU's Promotion of Women in Engineering, Research and Science (POWERS) programme and polytechnics' collaboration with the Singapore Women in Tech Initiative) to encourage female students to pursue STEM subjects and careers, and increased recognition and mentorship efforts for females in the STEM fields in Singapore. Both boys and girls also have equal opportunities to join a wide variety of co-curricular activities (CCA), catering to their interests and talents. Overall, the participation rate of females across the various CCA types is very healthy.

All educators are guided by the Ethos of the Teaching Profession and the Code of Professional Conduct for Educators. As educators play a role in building and maintaining an atmosphere of mutual trust and respect, they are expected to conduct themselves in a way that is professional, respectful and appropriate in their interactions. Wrongful practices or misconduct can be reported to the School Leader or the ministry and will be investigated and addressed accordingly.

- What challenges were encountered in achieving gender equality in and through education? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

Not applicable.

- Does the legal minimum age for marriage conform to international standards (18 years) ²³:

Please note that child marriage is a discriminatory practice as often girls can marry at a younger age than boys. Child marriage violates the child's right to education as they are more likely to drop out of school and children who are not in school are more likely to get married.

☒ Yes ☐ No

- Please provide reference to the relevant laws and provisions and indicate the exceptions to the legal age of marriage as well as the absolute minimum age:

Under the Women's Charter, marriages between persons either of whom is below 18 years of age are void. The only exception to this provision is where the marriage is authorised by a Special Marriage Licence issued by the Minister (see Section 9 of the Women's Charter) under conditions set out in Section 21A(2) of the Women's Charter as extracted below:

s9: Avoidance of marriages where either party is below 18

A marriage solemnised in Singapore or elsewhere between persons either of whom is below 18 years of age is void unless the solemnisation of the marriage was authorised by a special marriage licence.

s21A(2): Consents required for licences for minors who have not previously married

The Minister must not grant a special marriage licence for the marriage of a minor unless one of the following conditions is satisfied in relation to each person mentioned in the Second Schedule as a person whose consent is required for the marriage of the minor:

- a) the person consents to the marriage;
- b) the person refuses to consent to the marriage but the court consents to the marriage in lieu of the person;
- c) the Minister —
 - a. is satisfied that the consent of the person cannot be obtained because the person is absent, inaccessible or under a disability; and
 - b. dispenses with the consent of the person.

National minorities:

For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities.

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Legislation provides for the right to education of national minorities | ☒ Teachers are trained on intercultural education |
| ☒ Policy measures aim to enhance the right to education of national minorities | ☒ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation ²⁵ |
| ☐ Policy elaboration includes consultations with local communities | ☒ Multilingual and intercultural education are supported |
| ☒ The right to carry out their own educational activities is legally guaranteed for national minorities | ☒ Native language instruction is ensured for national minorities |

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☒ Educational standards are established for educational institutions run by national minorities | ☒ Adapting curricula and teaching and learning methods to their needs for national minorities |
| ☐ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for national minorities | ☒ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes ²⁶ and bias |
| ☐ Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for national minorities | |
| ☐ Other ²⁴ : | |

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

Singapore believes in education as a social leveller. All programmes and pathways are available to students, regardless of race, gender, or socio-economic background. The Constitution provides that “there shall be no discrimination against any citizen of Singapore on the grounds only of religion, race, descent or place of birth – (a) in the administration of any educational institution maintained by a public authority, and, in particular, the admission of pupils or students or the payment of fees; or (b) in providing out of the funds of a public authority financial aid for the maintenance or education of pupils or students in any educational institution (whether or not maintained by a public authority and whether within or outside Singapore).

Schools and Institutes of Higher Learning (IHLs) are committed to providing a supportive and safe environment for all students and staff, regardless of their race and religion. They provide a common space for students to learn and live out the values of respect and harmony and build a deeper appreciation of diversity in our society. To maintain this common space, our institutions stand firmly against any form of discrimination. The importance of racial and religious harmony, and respect for others, is taught through the formal and informal curriculum.

Educational institutions in Singapore have clear guidelines against unprofessional and discriminatory conduct. Specifically, respect for others is an integral part of the Codes of Conduct for both students and staff in the IHLs. All educators are expected to conduct themselves to the highest standards of their professions given their position of influence over students.

Students and staff who experience any form of discrimination are encouraged to bring it up to their institution immediately. Feedback channels and processes for students to do so include approaching senior staff or faculty members in person, via email channels and other formal feedback mechanisms. In schools, students are informed that they can raise any issues to their teachers or staff members. In IHLs, information on feedback channels is broadcasted on various platforms, including institutions’ websites, student handbooks and portals.

Singapore has maintained a bilingual policy since 1966. Bilingualism entails learning English and the respective official mother tongue languages (MTL) of the three main ethnic groups: Mandarin for the Chinese, Malay for the Malay community, and Tamil for the Indians. Some

²⁴ Please see: [UNESCO report](#) ‘The right to education of minorities: Overview of States’ measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023.

²⁶ Supra note 16.

flexibility is provided for students with reason to offer a different language in lieu of an official MTL: e.g., Non-Tamil speaking Indian students can apply to study one of the approved Non-Tamil Indian Languages, and students who have lived abroad for a long period of time and had formal learning in approved Foreign/Asian languages may apply to study one of these languages. The bilingual policy is a cornerstone of Singapore's education system. While English Language is the common language of communication in Singapore, all students are required to learn an MTL, which reflects our historical roots as a multicultural society and facilitates the transmission of our cultural heritage and values. Being able to listen and communicate in these MTL also helps our students to build confidence and connect with communities across Asia.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of minorities? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

Not applicable.

Indigenous people:

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Legislation provides for the right to education of indigenous people | ☐ Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for indigenous people |
| ☐ Policy measures aim to enhance the right to education of indigenous people | ☐ Teachers are trained on intercultural education |
| ☐ Policy elaboration includes consultations with local communities | ☐ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation ²⁷ |
| ☐ The right to carry out their own educational activities is legally guaranteed for indigenous people | ☐ Multilingual and intercultural education are supported |
| ☐ Educational standards are established for educational institutions run by indigenous people | ☐ Native language instruction is ensured |
| ☐ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for indigenous people | ☐ Adapting curricula and teaching and learning methods to their needs for indigenous people |
| ☒ Other: | ☐ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes ²⁸ and bias |

Not applicable.

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

Not applicable.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of indigenous people? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

²⁷ Supra note 15.

²⁸ Supra note 16.

Not applicable.

People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations²⁹:

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Legislation provides for their right to education | ☐ Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for |
| ☐ Policy measures aim to enhance their right to education | ☐ Auxiliary assistance is provided |
| ☐ Inclusion in mainstream schools is ensured | ☐ Multiple and flexible learning pathways ³² are provided |
| ☐ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for | ☐ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes ³³ and bias |
| ☐ All administrative barriers to access education are removed | ☐ Accelerated learning programmes are provided |
| ☐ Alternative administrative procedures (placement tests, portfolio of evidence, etc.) to overcome administrative barriers ³⁰ are provided for | ☐ Non-formal and/or alternative education programmes are provided |
| ☐ Teachers are specifically trained to ensure their inclusion | ☐ Language classes to newcomers are provided for |
| ☐ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation ³¹ | ☐ Multilingualism and intercultural education are encouraged |
| ☒ Other: | |

Not applicable.

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

Not applicable.

- Have specific measures been adopted for climate displaced persons?

☐ Yes ☒ No

- Please elaborate:

Not applicable.

²⁹ 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' ([UNESCO report](#): The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2).

³⁰ While lack of documentation (such as identity papers, birth certificates, residency permits, etc.) should not be an obstacle to access education, these can constitute a barrier to education See: [UNESCO publication](#): Handbook on the right to education, 2018, p. 96.

³¹ Supra note 15.

³² Supra note 13

³³ Supra note 16.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of migrants, refugees, asylum seekers, stateless persons and IDPs? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

Not applicable.

People with disabilities:

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☒ Legislation provides for their right to education | ☒ Mainstream teachers are specifically trained on disabilities |
| ☒ Policy measures aim to enhance their right to education | ☒ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation ³⁴ |
| ☒ Inclusion in mainstream schools is ensured | ☒ Auxiliary assistance is provided |
| ☒ Special schools are used as resource centers to inclusive schools | ☒ Curricula and teaching and learning methods are adapted |
| ☒ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided | ☒ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes ³⁵ and bias |
| ☒ Financial incentives and fellowships are provided | ☒ Education infrastructure and learning materials are adapted |
| ☐ Other | |

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

Singapore strives to be an inclusive and caring society to enable persons with disabilities to participate fully as integral and contributing members of society. In education, Singapore has been strengthening support for students with diverse learning needs, so that every child can maximise his/her potential. The majority of children with disabilities and special educational needs are enrolled in mainstream schools and around 20% of them are enrolled in government and community-funded Special Education (SPED) schools. Singapore's Compulsory Education Act, which was extended to include children with moderate-to-severe disabilities born after 1 Jan 2012, ensures that all children have the right to government-funded primary education, unless granted an exemption.

Students with disabilities in mainstream schools benefit from specialised manpower, including teachers and school-based personnel trained in implementing inclusive education practices in all schools. In SPED schools, students are supported by specially-trained teachers, together with allied professionals such as psychologists, therapists and social workers. SPED teachers attend a specialised pre-service training, the Diploma in Special Education, and can attend customised in-service courses conducted by training institutions.

To support students with disabilities, a range of educational programmes and services are available in mainstream schools, and government and community-funded SPED schools. In mainstream schools, case management teams coordinate intervention programmes and support services for students with disabilities in respective schools. To foster a positive peer support

³⁴ Supra note 15.

³⁵ Supra note 16.

culture, programmes such as the Circle of Friends³⁶ have been introduced, emphasising the importance of respect and empathy for others, including those who may be different from themselves. These values and social-emotional competencies are also reinforced in the Character and Citizenship Education Curriculum that is implemented for all students in all mainstream schools. Assistive learning devices and itinerant school-based educational support services are also provided to help students with disabilities access learning alongside their peers. SPED schools, which are resourced with specialised facilities, support students with higher needs who would benefit from more intensive and specialised interventions. Most SPED schools offer a customised curriculum. There are a few SPED schools which offer the national curriculum for students who can cognitively access it but have moderate-to-severe needs in their adaptive functioning. The National SPED Curriculum provides comprehensive guidance to SPED schools to enable them to customise a quality curriculum that equips their students with the knowledge, skills and attributes to lead independent lives, learn continuously and contribute meaningfully to society.

Beyond providing quality education, MOE also works closely with SPED schools, SG Enable³⁷ as well as employers and caregivers to support SPED students' transition to post-school pathways based on their interests, abilities and needs. For example, the School-to-Work Transition Programme provides SPED graduates who have diverse and more complex needs with customised place-and-train job training pathways to facilitate their transition to the workplace.

Students with disabilities who progress to the Institutes of Higher Learning (IHLs) continue to receive the necessary support. Each IHL has a Disability Support Office which coordinates support for students with disabilities from pre-enrolment to graduation. Examples include working with lecturers and tutors to establish access arrangements for students with disabilities, administering funds from MOE and/or the institution for students to purchase education-related Assistive Technology devices and support services, and implementing staff training on disability support. The Offices have also put in place various initiatives to prepare students with disabilities for the workforce, including working with Social Service Agencies (SSAs) to run mentorship programmes, internship placements and job matching programmes.

Education is heavily subsidised for Singaporean children in all schools, including SPED schools, such that families pay only a fraction of the cost of education. Singaporean children from lower-income families in SPED schools also have access to government financial assistance schemes which fully cover school fees, the cost of textbooks and school attire, and provide subsidies for school meals and public transport fees. In addition, all SPED schools administer their own financial assistance schemes to those who require more support.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of people with disabilities? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

Not applicable.

Students from poor households:

³⁶ Circle of Friends is a peer support intervention for students at risk of social-interaction difficulties in school contexts.

³⁷ SG Enable, the focal agency for disability and inclusion in Singapore, enables persons with disabilities to live, learn, work and play in an inclusive society.

- ☒ Financial incentives and fellowships for school enrolment are provided
- ☒ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation³⁸
- ☒ Transport, meals and education material are subsidised or provided free of charge beyond compulsory education
- ☒ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes³⁹ and bias
- ☐ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided
- ☐ Other:

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

Singapore has been strengthening support for students with diverse learning needs, so that every child can maximise her/her potential.

For the National Budget 2023, the Singapore Government stepped up efforts to support children from disadvantaged backgrounds. Lower-income families enjoy generous subsidies at government-supported preschools, including centres operated by Anchor Operators, Partner Operators or MOE Kindergartens with Kindergarten Care. They would also be encouraged to enrol their children in preschool by age three, so they can benefit sufficiently from preschool, learn alongside their peers and start their formal education on a stronger footing. To better support these children's attendance and learning needs, selected government-supported preschools will be provided with additional funding or manpower to strengthen their curriculum and professional capabilities.

Through the Character and Citizenship Education curriculum in schools, students are taught the importance of respect, care, empathy, and how to establish and respect boundaries for themselves and others.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of students from poor households? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

Not applicable.

2. Progress made with respect to implementing the right to education across all levels and forms of education

2.1 Early childhood care and education

For reference: Early childhood care and education (ECCE) is not explicitly provided for in the Convention/Recommendation. However, the international community has increasingly recognized the importance of ECCE over the years. The Committee on the Rights of the Child initially recognized "the right to education during early childhood as beginning at birth" (General Comment No. 7). This became

³⁸ Supra note 15.

³⁹ Supra note 16.

more explicit with the 2010 Moscow Framework for Action and Cooperation⁴⁰ and more recently, the Tashkent Declaration and Commitments to Action for Transforming Early Childhood Care and Education⁴¹. In the current context of the Education 2030 agenda, under SDG target 4.2, states have now committed to “the provision of at least one year of free and compulsory pre-primary education”.

- Please indicate the measures taken to ensure access to quality ECCE (several items may be ticked):

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Prior to pre-primary education, ECCE services are free | ☒ ECCE services respect a child’s need for early cognitive and social development, foundational learning, responsive care, nutrition, health, safety, protection, and play. |
| ☒ Prior to pre-primary education, ECCE services are affordable | |
| ☒ ECCE services are accessible on a non-discriminatory basis | |

- Please elaborate further on the measures taken:

The Government is committed to enhancing access to affordable and quality preschools to give every child a good start in life. The Government ensures that preschools remain affordable through provision of subsidies to parents of Singapore Citizen children, and fee caps (i.e. preschools cannot charge above a stipulated amount) at government-supported preschools. We are also increasing the number of government-supported preschool places, which allows more families to benefit from these lower fee caps. By around 2025, 80% of preschoolers can have a place in a government-supported preschool. Today, about 9 in 10 children aged 3 to 6 are enrolled in preschools.

To improve the quality of preschool providers, we introduced the Singapore Preschool Accreditation Framework (SPARK) in 2011. We will implement a revised SPARK 2.0 from January 2025, with a sharper focus on teaching and learning, more flexibility for preschools to develop their own programmes, and greater autonomy for preschools to take charge of their own quality journey. To raise the quality of early childhood (EC) programmes, we implemented national learning and development frameworks, the Nurturing Early Learners (NEL) framework and the Early Years Development Framework (EYDF), for children from birth to six. The Early Childhood Development Agency (ECDA) had recently updated the EYDF to better guide educators in planning and implementing meaningful learning experiences for children’s holistic development and well-being. The NEL Framework was revised in 2022, to provide updated guidelines for quality teaching and learning, including a stronger emphasis on developing children’s values, social and emotional competencies, and learning dispositions. The National Institute of Early Childhood Development (NIEC) has worked to enhance its courses to reflect latest industry practices and cater to a range of educators at different stages of their careers. NIEC courses take reference from Early Childhood Development Agency (ECDA)’s Early Years Development Framework (EYDF), MOE’s Nurturing Early Learners (NEL) Framework and the Skills Framework for Early Childhood. The NEL Framework was revised in 2022, to provide updated guidelines for quality teaching and learning, including a stronger emphasis on developing children’s values, social and emotional competencies, and learning dispositions.

In raising the quality of EC professionals, ECDA developed a Quality Teaching Tool (QTT) to establish a common standard for quality teaching in Singapore’s context. QTT focuses on

⁴⁰ Which states that “ECCE is part of the right to education and the main foundation for holistic human development”.
⁴¹ Which commits states to “Enhance policy and legal frameworks to ensure that the right to education includes ECCE”

the quality of teacher-child interaction and will help teachers evaluate their pedagogical practices. The National Institute of Early Childhood Development (NIEC) has also worked to enhance its courses to reflect latest industry practices and cater to a range of educators at different stages of their careers. NIEC courses take reference from ECDA's EYDF, MOE's NEL Framework and the Skills Framework for Early Childhood. We have also revised the Code of Ethics for EC professionals, expanding it to encompass practices for early intervention educators and to provide guiding principles and more actionable commitments.

- Is compulsory and free of charge pre-primary education available?

- ☐ Pre-primary education is compulsory. Please provide the age of enrolment and duration:

Not applicable.

- ☒ Pre-primary education is **not** compulsory.

- ☐ Pre-primary education is free of charge for all. Please provide the duration and indicate the extent to which it is free:

Not applicable.

- ☒ Pre-primary education is **not** free.

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.

The Singapore Government has ensured preschools remain affordable by providing preschool subsidies to all Singaporean children and imposing fee caps at government-supported preschools.

All Singapore Citizen (SC) children enrolled in an ECDA-licensed infant or childcare centre are eligible for a Basic Subsidy of up to \$600 for infant care and up to \$300 for childcare. Means-tested Additional Subsidy, on top of Basic Subsidy, is also available for eligible families. Eligible families whose children are enrolled in government-supported kindergarten programmes can benefit from means-tested kindergarten subsidies (Kindergarten Fee Assistance Scheme, or KiFAS).

In 2020, ECDA raised the monthly income ceiling for Additional Subsidy and KiFAS to \$12,000, and increased subsidy amounts across all eligible income tiers.

To keep fees at government-supported preschools affordable, we impose fee caps. These fee caps are supported by government grants to operators and have been steadily reduced over the years. By 2026, a dual-income family with a child enrolled in full-day childcare in a government-supported preschool will pay around the equivalent of primary school and after-school student care fees, before means-tested preschool subsidies. Fee caps at Government-supported preschools have also kept the median fees in the preschool sector stable and affordable despite the rising cost of preschool services. Industry median fees for infant care and childcare are lower today as compared to fees in 2013.

We are also increasing the number of government-supported preschool places, which allows more families to benefit from these lower fee caps.

The monthly fee for MOE Kindergartens (MK) in 2024 is \$160 for Singapore Citizens and \$320 for Singapore Permanent Residents, which includes complementary programmes such as field trips.

Uniforms inclusive of a polo T-shirt and khaki shorts/skorts are priced at S\$14-S\$15 (~US\$10-US\$11) per set.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing early childhood care and education and pre-primary education?

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Limited access | ☐ Poor learning outcomes |
| ☐ Issues of equity and inclusion | ☐ Low number of professionally trained educators |
| ☐ Poor quality programmes | ☐ Lack of support to families |
| ☒ Other: | |

None of the above.

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

Not applicable.

2.2 Primary and secondary education

For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for universal primary and secondary education. In the context of the Education 2030 agenda, SDG target 4.1 calls on States to provide “12 years of free, publicly funded, inclusive, equitable, quality primary and secondary education – of which at least nine years are compulsory.”

Primary education

- Please provide the age of enrolment and duration of primary education:

Primary education is a 6-year course of education normally commencing when a child has attained the age of 6 years.

- Is primary education compulsory and free of charge?

- | |
|---|
| ☒ Primary education is compulsory |
| ☐ Primary education is not compulsory. |
| ☐ Primary education is free of charge. |
| ☒ Primary education is not free. |

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.

In Singapore, the **Compulsory Education Act** requires Singapore Citizens residing in Singapore and born after 1 Jan 1996 to attend a national primary school regularly if they are of compulsory schooling age (above 6 years old and under 15 years old).

General education in Singapore is heavily subsidised by the Government. While Singapore Citizen students in primary education do not need to pay school fees, they pay monthly miscellaneous fees of S\$13 (~US\$9) which are a small fraction of the cost of education.

It is the Government's philosophy that parents pay a token amount of fees to share the responsibility for their children's education. There are financial assistance schemes available to further defray school fees for students who have difficulties paying, such that no child is deprived of education due to financial difficulties. We have achieved near-universal completion of secondary education, with over 97% of each Primary 1 cohort progressing to a post-secondary education institution.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education?

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Limited access | ☐ Poor learning outcomes in: |
| ☐ Issues of equity and inclusion | Foundation literacy |
| ☐ High dropout rates | Numeracy |
| ☐ Poor quality programmes | Social and emotional learning |
| ☒ Other: | Others |
| | ☐ Disparity in learning outcomes |
| | ☐ Low number of professionally trained teachers |

None of the above.

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

Not applicable.

Secondary education

In this part, please provide information on the general availability and accessibility to all of secondary education, including technical and vocational secondary education and training.

- Please provide the age of enrolment and duration of lower secondary education:

12 years old. 4 years.

- Please provide the age of enrolment and duration of upper secondary education:

16 years old. 2-3 years.

- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge?

- ☐ Lower secondary education is compulsory.
- ☒ Lower secondary education is **not** compulsory.
- ☐ Lower secondary education is free of charge.
- ☒ Lower secondary education is **not** free of charge.
- ☐ Upper secondary education is compulsory.
- ☒ Upper secondary education is **not** compulsory.
- ☐ Upper secondary education is free of charge
- ☒ Upper secondary education is **not** free of charge.

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.

General education in Singapore is heavily subsidised by the Government. Singapore Citizen students in primary education do not need to pay school fees, while those in secondary education pay monthly school fees of S\$5 (~US\$3) for secondary level and \$6 (~US\$4) for pre-university level respectively. They also pay monthly miscellaneous fees of \$13 (~US\$9) for primary level, S\$20 (~US\$14) for secondary level and S\$25 (~US\$18) for pre-university level respectively.

It is the Government's philosophy that parents pay a token amount of fees to share the responsibility for their children's education. There are financial assistance schemes available to further defray school fees for students who have difficulties paying, such that no child is deprived of education due to financial difficulties.

- Please indicate whether the legal minimum age for employment is aligned with the end of compulsory education:

For reference: The employment laws and those related to compulsory education are interdependent and mutually reinforce each other. If the minimum age of employment is below that of compulsory education, the child is at risk of dropping out of school to work and therefore not completing compulsory education. On the other hand, if compulsory education is lower than the minimum age of employment, once the child has completed compulsory education, the door is open to child exploitation and the violation of labour laws.

Yes ☐ No ☒

- Please provide reference to the relevant laws and provisions and indicate how the provision is enforced:

Not applicable.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education?

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Limited access | ☐ Poor learning outcomes |
| ☐ Issues of equity and inclusion | ☐ Low readiness of primary graduates |
| ☐ High dropout rates | ☐ Low number of professionally trained teachers |
| ☐ Poor quality programmes | |
| ☒ Other: | |

None of the above.

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

Not applicable.

2.3 Higher education

For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for higher education. Ensuring higher education is essential to achieve SDG4, both targets 4.3⁴², and target 4.4⁴³. Article 4 of the Convention requires states to make “higher education equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity”. Article 13 of the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966) further adds that this should be pursued by “every appropriate means, and in particular by the progressive introduction of free education”. Higher education includes technical and vocational education and training.

- Please indicate efforts made to ensure that higher education, including technical, vocation education and training, is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (*several items may be ticked*):

- ☐ Higher education is free of charge
- ☒ Higher education is accessible on the basis of individual capacity (as assessed by reference to relevant qualifications and experience)
- ☒ Higher education is accessible through financial incentives and scholarships
- ☐ Higher education is accessible through positive or affirmative action measures
- ☐ Higher education is accessible through credit transfer system between states

⁴² Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university”.

⁴³ Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”.

- ☒ Higher education allows for multiple and flexible learning pathways (flexible entry and re-entry, recognition, validation, and accreditation of knowledge and skills acquired through non-formal and informal education).

☐ Other:

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, university supplies, transport, accommodation). Brief quantitative information may be added.

Singapore actively enhances our post-secondary education landscape to prepare students for the future. Our Institutes of Higher Learning (IHLs) continually engage industry partners to ensure curriculum relevance and provide industry attachments, internships, work-study programmes and on-the-job upskilling. Admission to the IHLs is based on merit.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing higher education?

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Limited access | ☐ Low number of professionally trained professors |
| ☐ Issues of equity and inclusion | ☐ Insufficient mechanisms to ensure smooth transition from secondary to tertiary |
| ☐ Poor quality programmes | |
| ☐ Poor learning outcomes | |
- ☒ Other:

None of the above.

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

Not applicable.

2.4 Adult education and alternative learning

For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.”

- Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked):

- ☐ Provision of education for persons who have not received or completed the whole period of their primary education
- ☐ Provision of literacy programmes
- ☒ Provision of continuous learning (such as learning programmes to develop knowledge, skills, abilities, or competencies for personal and professional development)
- ☐ Provision of free of charge learning opportunities
- ☒ Provision of professional training including reskilling and upskilling programmes
- ☐ Recognition, validation and certification of non-formal and informal learning
- ☐ Provision of free of charge career guidance and counselling
- ☒ Lifelong learning entitlements including learning accounts, vouchers, etc.
- ☐ Other:

- Please elaborate further on the measures taken:

Singapore has a national **SkillsFuture** movement, where we have developed a high-quality Training and Adult Education ecosystem, comprising higher education institutions, private training providers and enterprises. They deliver a wide range of Continuing Education and Training (CET) programmes including short modular certificate courses that provide just-in-time skills top-up and longer-form full qualifications for more substantive upskilling and reskilling. Those eligible can access financial support provided by the Government, to make training more affordable and lower the opportunity cost for them to upskill and reskill. We are also providing more opportunities for fresh school leavers and adult learners to upgrade and attain qualifications via subsidised degree programmes, with the Lifetime Cohort Participation rate rising to 60% by 2025. In 2022, the Government invested S\$0.9 billion (≈US\$0.64 billion) in CET.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing adult learning and education?

- ☐ Limited access
- ☐ Limited funding
- ☐ Issues of equity and inclusion
- ☐ Poor learning outcomes
- ☐ Poor quality programmes
- ☐ Low number of professionally trained educators
- ☒ Other:

None of the above.

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

Not applicable.

3. Quality education provision and learning environment

For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2, 4(b) and 5(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for quality education. Quality education is fundamental to achieve all targets of SDG4. It is also particularly highlighted in SDG target 4.a that recommends states to “build and upgrade education facilities that are child, disability and gender sensitive and provide safe, non-violent, inclusive and effective learning environments for all”.

3.1 General measures

- Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding:

- ☒ State monitoring and inspections
- ☒ Health and sanitation
- ☐ Safety (children learn in a safe environment free from violence or harassment, including school-related gender-based violence (in and around schools))
- ☒ Infrastructure
- ☒ Curriculum
- ☒ Student-teacher ratio
- ☒ School fees (if relevant)
- ☐ Other

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

You may include information on policies, protocols or codes of conduct.

- **Education (Schools) Regulations** under the Education Act
- **Education (Grant-in-Aid) Regulations** under the Education Act

- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education?

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Non-supportive or inadequate learning environments | ☐ Low quality educational infrastructure and materials |
| ☐ Violence in schools | ☐ Inadequate parental support to education |
| ☐ Cost of education | ☐ Long distances to schools |
| ☐ Conflicts or crises | |

☒ Other:

None of the above.

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

Not applicable.

3.2 Education personnel

For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”.

- Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked):

- ☒ Teacher training is provided without discrimination.
- ☒ Teachers' average salaries are competitive or at least comparable to those paid in other professions requiring similar or equivalent qualifications (at all levels).
- ☒ Initial training and continuous professional development are provided.
- ☒ Minimum standards and qualifications required for the teaching profession.
- ☒ Measures taken to strengthen the social status and attractiveness of the teaching profession.
- ☒ Measures taken to promote diversity in the teaching workforce, including to redress gender imbalances at different levels of education.
- ☒ Establishment of performance monitoring systems.
- ☐ Measures taken to increase women in leadership positions in education.
- ☐ Other:

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

The National Institute of Education accredits and qualifies teachers of different teacher education levels. The Initial Teacher Education Programmes and Professional Development Programmes are available for teachers, school leaders and practitioners. Postgraduate programmes are also offered to award Masters and doctoral degrees in various disciplines including Education, Arts, Science and Psychology.

For primary, secondary and junior college teachers, the SkillsFuture for Educators initiative was launched in 2020 aims to improve teachers' competencies and encourage lifelong learning in 6 prioritised areas - Assessment Literacy, Differentiated Instruction, Inquiry-based Learning, E-pedagogy, Character and Citizenship Education, and Support for Students with Special Educational Needs.

Last, the Teacher Work Attachment Plus programme provides teachers short-term work attachments to organisations in the people, public or private sectors. Teachers are granted professional paid leave of 2-4 weeks to participate in work attachments, with provisions in place to cover their duties in schools. In 2023, the Academy of Singapore Teachers (AST) partnered more than 77 organisations across a diverse range of industries, offering around 450 work attachment opportunities, complemented with more than 2200 half-day learning journey placements under the programme and regular dialogue sessions with industry experts and thought leaders on current challenges and future opportunities. These professional learning opportunities broaden teachers' perspectives, keeping them abreast of the latest issues and emerging trends in the world beyond school. MOE appreciates the keen participation of industry partners and values their support in strengthening the capability of teachers to develop in students the 21st century competencies and dispositions to thrive in the world of life and work.

Efforts to strengthen and elevate the teaching profession include having a rigorous teacher selection process to hire people with the right values, dispositions and competencies, and who could teach well; providing attractive career development pathways that cater to teachers' different talents, abilities and aspirations; and offering our teachers rich and diverse professional learning opportunities to hone their craft; having a performance management system that balances performance and development; and employing various support mechanisms and programmes to support teachers' well-being including regular gathering of sentiments from teachers, Wellness Ambassadors in schools, targeted workshops, in-house professional counselling services, and access to government-wide well-being resources.

- What challenges were encountered in the education personnel?

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Shortages of teaching staff | ☐ Low quality educational infrastructure and materials |
| ☐ Lack of qualified, trained and motivated teaching staff | ☐ High student – teacher ratio |
| ☐ Lack of training centres | |
| ☒ Other: | |

None of the above.

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

Not applicable.

3.3 Respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms

For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms. This is covered under SDG target 4.7.⁴⁴ Please note that this section contributes to the general monitoring of Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation and that the future consultation on the 1974 Recommendation concerning Education for International Understanding, Co-operation and Peace and Education relating to Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms // 2023 Recommendation on [...] will be used specifically for monitoring SDG4 indicator 4.7.1.

- Please indicate the national efforts taken in directing education to the full development of the human personality and the strengthening of respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms (several items may be ticked):

- ☐ Curriculum includes human rights education.
- ☐ Educational and/or extracurricular activities are organized on human rights education.
- ☒ Other:

Through Character & Citizenship Education (CCE) curriculum, MOE aims to develop students with good character, resilience and social-emotional well-being, who are future-ready and will contribute as active citizens.

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

As early as preschool, students are taught the importance of showing care and respect for others. Educators design meaningful experiences for children. The learning goals are not gender-specific.

All students are taught that respect should be accorded. Students learn not to stereotype and to appreciate individuals for their unique qualities, strengths and talents.

In our national curriculum, students are exposed to a healthy representation of both women and men in all levels of schooling. The experiences, contributions, and achievements of women are highlighted alongside that of their male counterparts. Students have opportunities to discuss issues related to women's development, particularly in the languages and humanities subjects. In the Institutes of Higher Learning (IHLs), topics covered include the importance of healthy relationships and gender equality, and modules on respect and appropriate behaviour for students.

3.4 Non-state actors in education

For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision⁴⁵.

⁴⁴ Which calls on states to "ensure that all learners acquire the knowledge and skills needed to promote sustainable development, including, among others, through education for sustainable development and sustainable lifestyles, human rights, gender equality, promotion of a culture of peace and non-violence, global citizenship and appreciation of cultural diversity and of culture's contribution to sustainable development".

⁴⁵ Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors.

- Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked):

☐ Legal provisions prohibiting discrimination on the grounds listed by the Convention/Recommendation⁴⁶ explicitly apply to non-state educational institutions. Please specify:

☐ Policies aim to guarantee that the development of non-state education does not generate discrimination and that non-state actors offer a relevant alternative (without supplanting public education). Please specify:

☐ Legal provisions provide for the rights of the parents /legal guardians for providing religious and moral education for their children. Please specify:

☒ Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered:

- ☒ Registration
- ☒ State monitoring and inspections
- ☒ Qualifications of teachers
- ☒ Health and sanitation
- ☒ Safety (children learn in a safe environment free from violence or harassment, including school-related gender-based violence (in and around schools))
- ☒ Infrastructure
- ☒ Curriculum
- ☒ Student-teacher ratio
- ☒ School fees
- ☒ School closures
- ☐ Other

- Please elaborate:

⁴⁶ See: Article/Paragraph 1(1).

Private education institutions (PEIs) are required to comply with the Private Education Act and its Regulations, which set standards to safeguard consumer interest and promote informed decision-making.

- What challenges were encountered in non-state education provision?

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Low quality educational infrastructure and materials | ☐ Issues in terms of equity and inclusion |
| ☐ Low number of professionally trained teachers | ☐ Weak government regulatory and monitoring capacity |
| ☐ High student – teacher ratio | |
| ☒ Other: | |

None of the above.

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

Not applicable.

3.5 Digital education

Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion⁴⁷.

- Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked):

- ☐ Digital technology use in education is provided for in the legal framework.

Please indicate the relevant text and provisions:

- ☒ Core legislations, policies, strategies or plans for the management, privacy, security, storage, transfer, use, and sharing of education data internally and externally to ensure the right to privacy of learners and education stakeholders (e.g., informed consent, transparent usage policies, etc.)
- ☒ Regulatory framework establishes minimum education standards for digital education to which all actors in education must comply.
- ☒ Measures to remove barriers to accessing digital content⁴⁸, including ensuring access to curriculum-aligned digital content available on free, public, multi-modal national platforms; high-quality content

⁴⁷ Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital environment.

⁴⁸ Lack of internet connection, basic infrastructure or devices.

is available in core subjects, official national language(s), and designed with inclusive features to assist learners with disabilities.

☒ Digital skills incorporated into pre- and in-service teacher and leadership training curricula to create a culture of digital innovation and growth anchored in equity and inclusion that enables ongoing professional development for existing and emerging staff.

☒ Future-ready skills (including digital skills, data and AI competencies, critical thinking, etc.) integrated into formal curriculum at all levels of education

☐ Measures address the digital divide, including ensuring access to reliable electricity, meaningful internet connectivity at school and at home, devices suitable for learning and teaching, safe and sustainable software and secure platforms, and integrated education data systems.

☒ A well-established, sustainable, and cost-effective budget secured from a range of funding sources and intersectoral cooperation, supported by impact focused reporting linked to regional strategic goals.

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

As part of the National Digital Literacy Programme launched in 2020, every secondary school student owns a PLD such as a laptop or tablet since 2021 to access the SLS, Singapore's national online learning platform, and other educational technology tools and resources. The PLD enables students to benefit from active, technology-enabled learning experiences, and enhance their learning through the application of productivity tools. It also enables students to acquire digital skills and apply these skills as they navigate an increasingly digitalised world.

MOE has also provided all primary schools with sufficient internet-enabled devices to support students' learning in school. As recommended in the pilot study on primary school students' use of PLDs, and in line with the goals of the "Transforming Education Through Technology" Masterplan 2030, primary schools have been provided with computing devices for in-class use supervised by teachers so that students can reap the educational benefits of technology for teaching and learning. In cases where primary school students need to use devices after school hours but lack digital devices, schools can loan computers and internet-enabling devices to students who need to use the devices at home for school work. Students also have the option to use the computing facilities in school. Subsidised broadband and digital devices are also available to eligible low-income Singaporean households with school-going children via the Infocomm Media Development Authority's DigitalAccess@Home scheme.

As the national platform for teaching and learning, one of the key initiatives of the SLS is to transform the learning experiences of Singaporean students through the purposeful use of technology.

The SLS is continually being developed in response to the needs of students and teachers. Curriculum-aligned resources and system tools are continually being improved and developed in line with suggestions and feedback from teachers and students to cater to students' diverse and evolving learning needs.

Through the pre- and in-service teacher and leadership training curricula, NIE supports by providing the foundation and more advanced teacher-professional understanding and skills respectively to enable teachers to continually innovate in teaching with technology in an informed, equitable and inclusive manner.

To support the delivery of digital learning, teachers are provided with a range of professional development opportunities to develop their capacity in e-Pedagogy, including online courses, workshops, clinics, demonstration lessons, and milestone programmes. Teachers are also provided with resources such as a Guide to e-Pedagogy and subject-specific lesson examples designed with e-Pedagogy considerations.

In addition, MOE has set up the Singapore Learning Designers Circle (SgLDC) online networked learning community to provide teachers with a safe space to share technology-enabled lessons, crowdsource for lesson ideas, help each other trouble-shoot technical challenges, and render support and encouragement as they learn to teach effectively with technology.

MOE launched the "Transforming Education through Technology" (EdTech) Masterplan 2030 in September 2023 to harness the transformative potential of technology in teaching and learning for the General Education sector to further address and seize the opportunities of the post-COVID landscape. This is done through (i) enhancing the development of our students' digital literacy and technological skills needed to thrive in an increasingly technology-saturated future; (ii) leveraging new technologies, such as Artificial Intelligence, to better customise learning for every child; and (iii) strengthening and scaling the culture of sharing and adapting technology-enabled lessons, resources, and good practices across all schools. Initiatives under the EdTech Masterplan 2030 will be implemented in schools progressively from 2024.

Under the EdTech Masterplan 2030, MOE is strengthening students' digital literacy, including digital information management skills, so that they are able to better discern the accuracy, credibility, and relevance of information. MOE will also strengthen students' technological skills, starting with AI literacy to equip students with knowledge about AI, and its applications for their learning and for life.

- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)?

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Lack of quality, curriculum-aligned digital teaching and learning content that supports flexible learning and teaching pathways | ☐ Limited access to internet and/or electricity |
| ☐ Lack of equity and inclusion in digital learning solutions | ☐ Limited access to hardware (devices, chargers, etc.) |
| ☐ inadequate safety measures and IT support to respond to issues of child online safety or reduce cyber security risks | ☐ Difficulty in regulating the use of digital education solutions |
| ☒ Other: | ☐ Difficulty in sustainably financing digital education solutions at national scale |
| | ☐ Lack of digital skills development for meaningful use of digital technology in teaching practice |
| | ☐ Disjointed or fragmented solutions that are not centrally systematized or regulated |

None of the above.

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

Not applicable.

4 Strengthening governance systems

For reference: The Education 2030 Framework for Action states "to ensure quality education and conditions for effective education outcomes, governments should strengthen education systems by instituting and improving appropriate, effective and inclusive governance and accountability mechanisms; quality assurance; management information systems; transparent and effective financing procedures and mechanisms; and institutional management arrangements, as well as ensure that robust, timely and accessible data are available" (para. 18).

- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked):

☒ Monitoring mechanisms to assess compliance with the right to education obligations, including through management information systems.

☒ Monitoring results are made public. Please provide the link:

- SDG4 Indicators (<https://www.singstat.gov.sg/find-data/sdg/goal-4>)
- Education Statistics Digest (<https://www.moe.gov.sg/about-us/publications/education-statistics-digest>)
- Data.gov.sg (<https://data.gov.sg>)

☐ Monitoring processes are participatory, inclusive and regular.

☒ Sector-wide and multisector approach is adopted to education governance.

☐ Financial resources are effectively allocated to prioritise the provision of free, quality, public education and are adequately budgeted for in government plans.

☐ The decision-making process for the allocation of resources to education is transparent.

☐ Ensuring crisis-sensitive and disaster risk-informed planning and programming, including the provision of quality education in emergencies.

☐ There is a certain degree of decentralization in favour of local public authorities and autonomy for schools to ensure context relevance of their teaching.

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

- What challenges were encountered in terms of governance?

- ☐ Budgetary constraints
- ☐ Lack of involvement of relevant stakeholders and lack of cooperation/coordination at different levels
- ☐ Poor dialogue with teachers' trade unions
- ☒ Other:
- ☐ Absence of supportive/ inconsistent/obsolete legal and policy environment
- ☐ Lack or weakness of monitoring systems – including the lack of reliable data

None of the above.

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

Not applicable.

III. Methods used to draw the attention of the various authorities in the country to the instruments

For reference: UNESCO governing bodies have underlined the need for awareness raising. Given the importance of normative action at the national level, wide dissemination of the Convention must be ensured, with the support of National Commissions for UNESCO.

- Have activities been carried out to draw the attention of the various authorities of the country to the Convention/Recommendation and their provisions about the right to education and to raise awareness of the principles of non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities? (Several items may be ticked)

- ☐ Translation of the Convention/Recommendation into the national and possibly local languages
- ☐ Dissemination and advocacy of the core content of the Convention/Recommendation or the core principles of the right to education including through appropriate materials and resources
- ☐ Activities undertaken or supported by the National Commission to promote non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities and to foster debate on critical issues in relation to the rights enshrined in the instruments
- ☒ Other:

None of the above.

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